

UNIT 10

Demand Generation

PMM & Demand Gen Partnership

Future of PMM Academy

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Overview

Product marketing and demand generation are often siloed—PMM creates positioning, demand gen runs campaigns, and neither understands the other's constraints. This unit bridges the gap, teaching PMMs how to partner effectively with demand generation teams, support campaign execution, and think about pipeline contribution without losing strategic focus.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

- Build effective partnerships between PMM and demand generation
- Design campaign briefs that translate positioning into execution
- Support demand generation with messaging, content, and targeting
- Understand pipeline metrics and PMM's influence on them
- Align PMM activities to demand generation rhythms and goals

Section 1: The PMM-Demand Gen Relationship

Why It's Complicated

PMM and demand gen often frustrate each other:

PMM Complaints - "They're not using our messaging" - "The campaigns don't reflect our positioning" - "They only care about lead volume, not quality" - "They make tactical decisions without strategy input"

Demand Gen Complaints - "The messaging doesn't convert" - "They don't understand performance constraints" - "Everything takes too long" - "They don't give us content we can actually use"

The Fundamental Tension

PMM thinks in **positioning and differentiation**—long-term brand building and competitive advantage.

Demand gen thinks in **conversion and efficiency**—this quarter's pipeline and this month's leads.

Both are right. Both are incomplete. The best PMMs learn to speak both languages.

Working Model

Effective PMM-demand gen partnerships divide responsibilities clearly:

PMM Owns - Messaging and positioning - Targeting strategy and ICPs - Content strategy and creation - Competitive context - Campaign briefs and creative direction

Demand Gen Owns - Channel strategy and execution - Budget allocation and optimization - Performance measurement - Testing and iteration - Technology and operations

Shared Ownership - Campaign strategy - Audience development - Results analysis and learning - Pipeline accountability

Section 2: Campaign Briefs That Work

What a Campaign Brief Does

A campaign brief translates PMM strategy into execution requirements. Good briefs:

- Provide enough direction to stay on strategy
- Allow enough flexibility for performance optimization

- Document decisions so teams can move fast
- Create shared accountability for outcomes

Campaign Brief Structure

Strategic Context - Business objective: What's the goal beyond leads? - Target audience: Who exactly are we trying to reach? - Competitive context: What are we against? - Positioning: Why us vs. alternatives?

Campaign Requirements - Messaging: Key messages and supporting points - Offers: What are we offering? (content, demo, consultation?) - Creative direction: Tone, visual guidance, examples - Success metrics: What does good look like?

Tactical Framework - Channels: Where should this run? - Timeline: When does it launch, end, need checkpoints? - Budget guidance: What resources are available? - Assets needed: What content must be created?

Brief Anti-Patterns

Briefs fail when they:

- **Over-specify execution:** Don't dictate ad copy word-for-word
- **Under-specify strategy:** "Generate leads" isn't a strategy
- **Ignore constraints:** Demand gen has budget and resource limits
- **Skip context:** Why now? Why this audience? Why this message?

Section 3: Supporting Campaign Execution

Content for Campaigns

Demand gen campaigns need specific content types:

Top-of-Funnel - Educational content that earns attention - Thought leadership that builds credibility - Industry insights that demonstrate expertise

Middle-of-Funnel - Solution overviews and product information - Comparison guides and evaluation criteria - Case studies and proof points

Bottom-of-Funnel - ROI calculators and business cases - Implementation guides - Trial and demo experiences

PMM should build content with campaign usage in mind—modular pieces that can be combined and adapted for different contexts.

Messaging for Performance

Positioning messaging and performance messaging aren't identical:

Positioning Messaging - Comprehensive and nuanced - Covers multiple value dimensions - Built for depth of understanding

Performance Messaging - Concise and punchy - Single-minded value proposition - Built for quick comprehension and action

PMM should provide messaging hierarchies that demand gen can adapt—clear priorities on what to emphasize when space is limited.

Targeting Support

PMM brings targeting intelligence demand gen can't generate alone:

- **ICP Refinement:** Which accounts and personas to prioritize?
- **Trigger Events:** What signals indicate buying readiness?
- **Exclusions:** Who shouldn't we target (and why)?

- **Competitive Context:** Which competitor install bases to target?

Section 4: Pipeline Metrics for PMMs

Understanding the Funnel

PMMs should understand how pipeline works:

Volume Metrics - Leads: Named contacts showing interest - MQLs: Leads meeting qualification criteria - SQLs: Leads sales accepts as worth pursuing - Opportunities: Active deals in pipeline - Closed-Won: Deals that convert to revenue

Efficiency Metrics - Conversion rates between stages - Velocity through stages - Cost per lead/MQL/SQL/opportunity - Pipeline coverage (pipeline ÷ quota)

Where PMM Influences Pipeline

PMM doesn't own pipeline directly but influences it everywhere:

Early Stage (Leads → MQLs) - Messaging relevance increases engagement - Content quality improves lead capture - Targeting accuracy raises MQL rates

Middle Stage (MQLs → SQLs) - Differentiation clarity improves qualification - Competitive positioning supports rep conversations - Sales enablement prepares reps for discovery

Late Stage (SQLs → Closed-Won) - Objection handling materials support closing - Proof points overcome skepticism - Competitive intelligence addresses alternatives

Pipeline Accountability

PMMs should accept appropriate accountability:

Fair Accountability - Messaging effectiveness (do campaigns using your messaging perform better?) - Content engagement (are people consuming what you create?) - Sales enablement adoption (do reps use your materials?)

Unfair Accountability - Lead volume (campaign execution drives this) - Cost per lead (budget and channel decisions drive this) - Sales conversion (too many factors outside PMM control)

Section 5: Rhythms and Rituals

Aligning with Demand Gen Cadence

Demand gen operates on regular cycles:

Weekly - Performance reviews - Tactical adjustments - Content needs identification

Monthly - Campaign reviews - Budget allocation - Planning for next month

Quarterly - Strategy reviews - Major campaign planning - Pipeline forecasting

PMMs should attend key meetings and understand the rhythm to provide inputs at the right moments.

Joint Planning Sessions

Regular joint sessions between PMM and demand gen should cover:

What's working: Which messages, content, audiences are performing? **What's not:** Where are we missing? Why? **What's next:** Upcoming launches, campaigns, priorities? **What's needed:** Content gaps, messaging questions, targeting guidance?

Feedback Loops

Build systematic feedback channels:

- Campaign performance data shared with PMM
- Sales feedback on lead quality
- Content engagement metrics
- Win/loss insights on campaign-generated deals

Key Takeaways

1. PMM and demand gen are partners—learn to speak both languages
2. Campaign briefs should provide direction without micromanaging execution
3. Build content and messaging with campaign usage in mind
4. Understand pipeline metrics and where PMM influences them
5. Align with demand gen rhythms and build regular feedback loops

Assessment

Complete the Unit 10 assessment (10 questions, 80% to pass) to unlock the next unit.

Lab Exercise

Campaign Brief Lab: Use AI to build a comprehensive campaign brief for a product launch, including messaging hierarchy, content requirements, targeting guidance, and success metrics aligned to pipeline goals.